

Vaginal Bleeding

History

- Is the patient pregnant? Possibly pregnant? Due date?
- If pregnant, has the pregnancy been normal? Previous vaginal bleeding?
- Does the patient have a history of miscarriages? Ectopic pregnancy? Premature deliveries?
- Does the patient smoke? Drink alcohol? Use cocaine? (All of these increase risk for placental abruption)
- When did the bleeding start?
- Is the patient having pain or is the bleeding painless?
- How long does it take to soak a pad?
- Does the patient have other medical issues?
- Does she take medications? Blood thinners? (Plavix, Pradaxa, Lovenox, Coumadin, etc.)

Physical

- Vitals signs – Is the patient in shock?
- Mental status – Is the patient in shock?
- Abdominal exam – Is uterus tender? Obvious contractions?
- Visual genital exam – Obvious bleeding? Severe bleeding? Can you see fetal part protruding?
- Signs of other trauma? Abuse?

Serious Causes of Vaginal Bleeding

- **Ectopic pregnancy** – may or may not have abdominal pain
- **Abruptio placentae** (placental abruption) – usually has moderate to severe abdominal pain
- **Uterine rupture** – severe abdominal pain, patient will likely be in shock
- **Spontaneous abortion (miscarriage)**
- **Placenta previa** – bright red vaginal bleeding, often painless
- **Abdominal / pelvic trauma**
- **Post-partum hemorrhage**
- **Uterine / endometrial cancer** – vaginal bleeding in patient past menopause is suspicious for cancer

EMT/AEMT

- Follow General Medical Care Guideline

Patient is Not Pregnant

- Secondary survey

Patient is Pregnant ≤ 12 weeks Gestation (first trimester)

- Secondary survey

Patient is Pregnant > 12 weeks Gestation (second or third trimester)

- Advanced airway as indicated
- Monitor closely for fetal protrusion or delivery

EMT/AEMT - Expanded Scope

- Pain management - Acetaminophen only for known pregnancy
- **NS/LR** 500ml IO if needed

Paramedic

- Advanced airway as indicated
- **NS/LR** 500 – 2000mL IV / IO bolus to maintain SBP > 90
- Pain management per Pain Management Guideline

Patient is Pregnant > 12 weeks Gestation

- Transport patient on left side if possible
- Notify hospital early if significant bleeding so an OB team can be assembled

